

Personas and User Stories

1) Ethan, the Grade-Focused Achiever

Ethan:	Description:
 Image generated with OpenAI's DALL·E	• Age: 23 • Background: Competitive student aiming for grad school. • Goals: Wants to keep a close eye on grades & projections. • Frustrations: Unsure of final outcomes until the end of term; struggles to know if he's meeting his GPA goals. • Needs from ClassMate: Automatic grade projections, goal setting, and warnings when falling short.
User Stories: ● As a grade-focused student, I want the system to calculate my current and projected grades so that I can track whether I'm on target to reach my academic goals. ● As a grade-focused student, I want personalized study suggestions based on my weaker courses so that I can improve where I'm falling behind. ● As a grade-focused student, I want to compare my current standing with the class average so that I can assess my competitiveness. ● As a grade-focused student, I want to highlight "at risk" courses in red so that I can quickly see where I need the most effort.	

2) Liam, the Mature Student Returning to School

Liam:	Description:
 Image generated with OpenAI's DALL·E	● Age: 32 ● Background: Returning to college after years in the workforce; juggling family responsibilities. ● Goals: Wants to stay organized without feeling overwhelmed. ● Frustrations: Feels rusty with academic planning and often loses track of multiple deadlines. ● Needs from ClassMate: Clear roadmap of assignments, ability to prioritize, and weekly summary emails.
User Stories: ● As a mature student, I want to receive a weekly email summary of upcoming deadlines so that I can plan my study time around family responsibilities. ● As a mature student, I want a “big picture” semester timeline so that I can prepare for busy weeks in advance. ● As a mature student, I want to set recurring reminders for weekly study sessions so that I build consistent habits. ● As a mature student, I want a simple progress tracker that shows completed vs. remaining tasks so that I can feel a sense of accomplishment.	

3) Olivia, the Online/Remote Learner

Olivia:	Description:
 <i>Image generated with OpenAI's DALL·E</i>	● Age: 21 ● Background: Takes most classes online; rarely on campus. ● Goals: Wants reliable organization without relying on physical reminders. ● Frustrations: Easily loses track of online announcements and course emails. ● Needs from ClassMate: Centralized dashboard that pulls all deadlines together, with push notifications.
User Stories: ● As a remote learner, I want all my online deadlines centralized in one place so that I don't miss important announcements or submissions. ● As a remote learner, I want to join group task boards so that I can collaborate with classmates online more easily. ● As a remote learner, I want automatic updates when professors change deadlines online so that I don't miss last-minute adjustments. ● As a remote learner, I want a "do not disturb" setting during exams so that I don't get distracted by notifications.	

4) Sofia, the Student with ADHD

Sofia:	Description:
 Image generated with OpenAI's DALL·E	● Age: 19 ● Background: First-year student recently diagnosed with ADHD. ● Goals: Wants to stay on top of coursework without feeling scattered. ● Frustrations: Overwhelmed by long assignment lists; forgets deadlines unless they're broken into smaller steps. ● Needs from ClassMate: Visual reminders, ability to break big assignments into smaller tasks, and daily nudges.
User Stories: ● As a student with ADHD, I want to break assignments into smaller tasks with daily reminders so that I can stay focused and avoid last-minute stress. ● As a student with ADHD, I want the option to “snooze” or reschedule reminders so that I don’t feel overwhelmed when busy. ● As a student with ADHD, I want assignments displayed one step at a time so that I can focus without distractions. ● As a student with ADHD, I want to break large readings into smaller, timed sessions so that I can manage my focus better. ● As a student with ADHD, I want the app to surface only 3–5 priority tasks daily so that I don’t get overwhelmed by the full list.	

5) Marcus, the Part-Time Worker

Marcus:	Description:
 Image generated with OpenAI's DALL·E	● Age: 22 ● Background: Full-time student, works 20 hours a week at a café. ● Goals: Needs to balance work shifts and school deadlines. ● Frustrations: Forgets due dates when juggling changing work schedules. ● Needs from ClassMate: Mobile-first reminders, ability to sync school deadlines with a work calendar.
User Stories: ● As a part-time worker, I want my school deadlines synced with my work calendar so that I can avoid scheduling conflicts and missed assignments. ● As a part-time worker, I want automatic reminders when a due date is less than 24 hours away so that I don't lose track after long shifts. ● As a part-time worker, I want to auto-block study time around my work shifts so that I always reserve space for school. ● As a part-time worker, I want notifications that escalate in urgency (e.g., 3 days -> 1 day -> hours left) so that I stay aware of deadlines.	

6) Aisha, the International Student

Aisha:	Description:
 <i>Image generated with OpenAI's DALL·E</i>	● Age: 20 ● Background: Exchange student from overseas; English is her second language. ● Goals: Wants clear communication of tasks and a simple way to keep track of multiple courses. ● Frustrations: Confused by academic terminology in emails and unfamiliar with local systems. ● Needs from ClassMate: Simple, clear-language reminders and icons/visual cues that make deadlines easier to understand.
User Stories: ● As an international student, I want simple, visual reminders for assignments so that I can understand tasks easily despite language barriers. ● As an international student, I want to see deadlines in my home country's time zone as well as the local time zone so that I don't get confused. ● As an international student, I want the option for notifications in multiple languages so that I can pick whichever feels most comfortable. ● As an international student, I want step-by-step exam prep checklists so that I can build confidence with structured guidance.	